

# Marieta du Plessis

Professor of Leadership and Organisational Behaviour · Registered Industrial Psychologist

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## Current Position

Professor of Leadership and Organisational Behaviour, Stellenbosch Business School, Stellenbosch University (April 2026 – current). Head, Centre for Responsible Leadership Studies (Africa). Extraordinary Professor, Department of Industrial Psychology, University of the Western Cape, and Optentia Research Unit, North-West University.

## Research Focus

Leadership development · organisational behaviour · positive organisational psychology · leadership in higher education. NRF-rated researcher.

## Qualifications

- PhD, Industrial Psychology – University of the Western Cape, 2014
- Postgraduate Diploma in Higher Education – University of the Western Cape, 2018
- MA, Industrial Psychology – Stellenbosch University, 2007
- BA Honours, Industrial Psychology – Stellenbosch University, 2003

## Professional Registration

Registered Industrial Psychologist, Health Professions Council of South Africa (PS 0104388), since 2007. Chartered HR Practitioner (Learning & Development), SABPP. Member, Society for Industrial and Organisational Psychologists of South Africa (SIOPSA).

## Academic Career

- Professor and Centre Head, Centre for Responsible Leadership Studies (Africa) – Stellenbosch Business School (2026–current)
- Professor, Industrial Psychology – University of the Western Cape (2011–2026); Acting Head of Department (2014–15, 2025–26); promoted to Full Professor 2023
- Independent practice and consulting – Industrial Psychologist, coach and facilitator (2004–2011, ongoing ad hoc)

## Leadership & Research Networks

- Lead Partner, LEAD Academic Network – keynote speaker and academic contributor; lead organiser, 2025 LEAD Academic Network Annual Symposium, Cape Town
- Co-Convenor, WERA International Research Network on Digital Academic Leadership in the New Era
- Section Editor, South African Journal of Industrial Psychology (2016–2026); reviewer for SAJHRM, European Business Review, Frontiers, and NRF funding/rating panels

## Selected Grants & Awards

- NRF Human and Social Dynamics in Development grant, 2018–2021
- UWC Developmental Research Chair grant, 2022–2024
- Institutional Academic Achiever Award (Best Mid-Career Researcher), UWC, 2020
- UWC Research Recognition Award: Women in Leadership, 2022 & 2024
- Dean's Award: Lecturer of the Year, EMS Faculty, 2014

## **Publications**

44 journal articles, 6 book chapters, and 20+ conference papers/proceedings on leadership, academic careers, workplace wellbeing, and workplace counselling. Selected and grouped list: see the Publications page. Full list: Google Scholar profile.

## **Postgraduate Supervision**

44 Master's and 6 doctoral theses supervised to completion; 76 external and 22 internal Master's examinations; 21 external doctoral examinations. Currently supervising 5 PhD and 1 Master's student.

## **Teaching**

MBA Leadership Development (module coordinator) and Organisational Behaviour; postgraduate diploma modules in Responsible Leadership and Leadership Development; undergraduate and honours courses in Organisational Behaviour, Human Resource Management, Positive Organisational Psychology, Coaching and Mentoring, and Occupational Counselling.

Full academic CV (career history, complete publication and supervision record) available on request.